Table 4.3 Nutritive value of Fish (per 100 g)					
Food item	**Energy (Kcal)**	**Protein (g)**	**Fat (g)**	**Calcium (mg)**	**Iron (mg)**
Pomfret -black (Vavalu)	111	20.3	2.6	286	2.3
Prawn (Yera)	89	19.1	1.0	323	5.3
Sardine (Mathi)	101	21.0	1.9	90	2.5
Seer (Vanjaram)	126	22.5	4.0	71	5.4

water fish contains eicosapentaenoic acid and docosahexaenoic acid which are ω-3 polyunsaturated fatty acids.

Minerals: Fish is rich in calcium particularly small fish when eaten with bones. Marine fishes are good sources of iodine, selenium and fluoride. Selenium is a powerful antioxidant. Oysters are good source of copper and iron. Sodium content of freshwater fish is slightly less than meat. Shell fish such as oysters are nature's richest source of zinc. The bioavailability of iron and zinc is higher in fish than plant foods.

Vitamins: Sea foods contain significant amount of vitamin B_{12} especially shell fishes. Fish liver oils are excellent source of fat-soluble vitamins. Shark liver oil contains 10,000-24,000 IU of vitamin A per gram of oil. Rohu contains vitamin C. Fishes are good source of niacin and vitamin D. Sea foods contain significant amounts of vitamin B_{12} especially shell fishes.

Fish and health

Eskimos living in Greenland and the fishing community in Japan, enjoy complete freedom from cardiovascular diseases. Their

Table 4.4 Selection of Fish		
Characteristics	**Fresh fish**	**Stale fish**
Skin	Bright, moist and shiny	Skin shows signs of wrinkling and shrinking away from the flesh
Scales	Firmly attached to the skin	Falls off easily
Eyes	Eyes should be convex, the pupil black and the cornea translucent. The eyes should be bright, clear and bulging.	Sunken eyes
Bones	Bones stick firmly to the flesh	The bone separates easily from the flesh
Flesh	Firm to touch	Should not leave a depression when touched
Gills	Bright red in colour	Brown

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